JAMES WILLIAM HARTLEY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven and highly motivated Staff Backend Engineer with a proven track record of spearheading mission-critical system architectures and delivering cutting-edge solutions. Leveraging 10 years of expertise in designing scalable distributed systems, I champion cross-functional collaboration to drive organisational objectives and actionable insights. Passionate about delivering value through data-driven decision making and synergistically innovating dynamic technical solutions to unlock competitive advantage.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Backend Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

www.synapsedata.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Architected and led the development of a high-throughput event streaming platform processing 500K+ events per second, reducing latency by 40% and improving system reliability to 99.99% uptime.

Designed and implemented microservices infrastructure using Kubernetes and Docker, enabling the engineering team to scale from 15 to 50 backend engineers while maintaining code quality and deployment velocity.

Established comprehensive monitoring and observability standards across 200+ services using Prometheus, ELK stack, and custom alerting systems, reducing mean time to resolution by 35%.

Mentored and developed 8 junior and mid-level engineers, with 3 subsequently promoted to senior roles, while driving technical excellence through code review standards and architectural governance.

Senior Backend Engineer

Sky UK

www.sky.com

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Led the redesign and migration of legacy monolithic streaming backend to event-driven microservices architecture, handling 2M+ concurrent users and reducing infrastructure costs by 30%.

Implemented distributed transaction patterns and saga-based workflows for payment processing systems, ensuring consistency across multiple services and eliminating data reconciliation issues.

Collaborated with product and data teams to build real-time analytics pipeline ingesting 100GB+ daily data volume, enabling business intelligence reporting and reducing decision-making cycles.

Drove security improvements by implementing API gateway authentication, service mesh policies, and infrastructure-as-code practices, achieving SOC2 Type II compliance certification.

Backend Engineer

TechCore Solutions Ltd

www.techcore-solutions.com

Manchester, United Kingdom

July 2014 - May 2019

Developed and maintained core Java-based REST APIs serving 15M+ requests daily, implementing caching strategies and database query optimization to improve response times by 50%.

Built comprehensive CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitLab CI, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to 10 minutes and enabling 20+ deployments per day with zero-downtime releases.

Implemented database sharding strategy for MySQL databases supporting rapid user growth, managing 50GB+ datasets while maintaining query performance below 100ms P99 latency.

Contributed to architectural decisions and technology evaluations, successfully advocating for migration from traditional monolith to containerized services, laying foundation for company scalability.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2014

GPA: 2:1 (Upper Second Class Honours)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, Bash

Databases and Data Systems: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Apache Kafka, Elasticsearch

Distributed Systems: Microservices architecture, Event-driven systems, Saga patterns, Distributed transactions, Load balancing

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Apache Airflow

Observability and Monitoring: Prometheus, ELK Stack, Datadog, Grafana, custom alerting systems

Concepts and Methodologies: SOLID principles, Design patterns, API design, System design, Agile, Code review practices